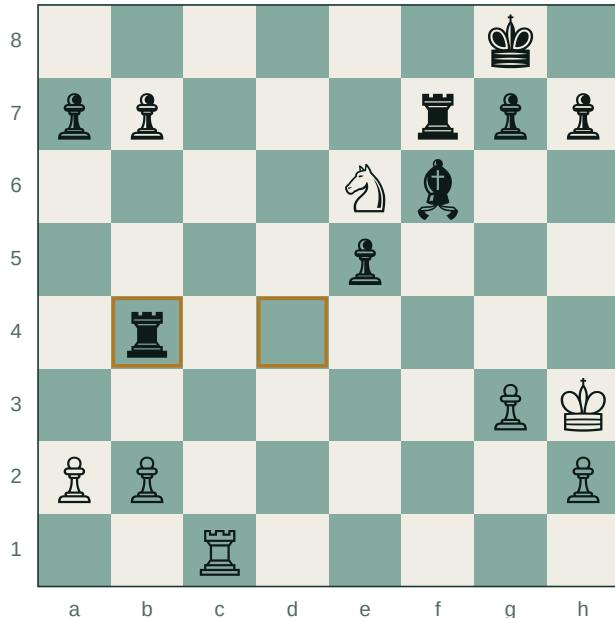


# Mate in three: White, move 29

Mate in three

White to move



Previous move: 28...Rxb4. Gold borders mark its start and finish.

**WORKED CONTINUATION - COVER THIS SECTION FIRST**

**29. Rc8+ Bd8 30. Rxd8+ Rf8 31. Rxf8#**

**29.Rc8+** Check restricts Black to 2 legal replies here. Recorded reply: **29...Bd8**.

**30.Rxd8+** Check restricts Black to 1 legal reply here. The move also takes the bishop on d8. Recorded reply: **30...Rf8**.

**31.Rxf8#** Mate: rook on f8 gives check; Black has no legal reply.

The line ends in checkmate against the king on g8. Material gain is unnecessary once no legal defense exists.

**CHECKPOINT**

Which piece delivers the final check, and why can the defender not continue? **Answer:** Rook on f8. The king is in check and the position has zero legal replies.

**CARRY THE IDEA INTO YOUR GAMES**

Do not stop at a promising check. The final mating position must still be legal after every intervening move.

**WHAT THIS POSITION TEACHES**

Longer mating lines require accurate visualization. Track the king's square, opened lines, and every sacrificed piece through the entire sequence.

**HOW TO LOOK**

Work backward from a mating pattern, then calculate forward with the opponent choosing the strongest defense.

The defending king is on g8. Geometrically undefended: rook on b4. Check for tactical protection.